

# Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

## Sell Nothing For Anything

**Y**ou can sell anything on eBay. In fact, you can also sell 'nothing' on it, as people have done in the past. But news is made by people selling next to nothing, for quite a lot of money.

Jay Loewer, from the US, had an old beer can lying about his house for as long as he could remember. The front of the



can has a camel draped with a blanket that reads "Are you thirsty".

His friends suggested it might fetch him some money. Well it did—\$10,999.99 (Rs 5,06,000) to be exact.

Three cheers for eBay, and remember, be careful what you throw away!

## Putin' A High Stake

**A** Web site (*Kavkazcenter.com*) hosted on Lithuanian soil pledged \$20 million for the capture of Russian President Vladimir Putin. The Web site has accused the President of war crimes.

The Russian Foreign Ministry wasted no time in requesting Lithuania's ambassador Rimantas Sidlauskas to pull the shutters on the offending Web site.

The request was denied. The site used to operate from servers in the US and Britain, but was removed after it was accused of being a source of spam. It is now hosted by Elneta on a server located in the apartment of renowned Soviet-era dissident and political prisoner Viktoras Petkus.

The Lithuanian Foreign Ministry said that the site cannot be shut down as yet. A court ruling is expected next year from the country's Constitutional Court on a pending case. The case will determine the site whether goes against the Lithuanian law.



Vladimir Putin: The 20-million-dollar President!

## Follow That Nose!

**Y**ou move your head and the cursor follows your nose. Blink the right eye and it is translated to a right-click, blink the left one for a left-click.

Dmitry Gorodnichy, an inventor from the Institute of Information Technology, Ottawa, has developed a computer navigation system that uses your nose to direct a cursor, *New Scientist* reports.

The nose-steered mouse is expected to make using a computer easier for people with disabilities, or for gamers who would like nothing better than to slay monsters with a blink of an eye or play tennis by bobbing the head.

The technology uses a USB-connected Web cam to track the user's nose. Gorodnichy chose the nose because it is the easiest facial feature to track. Motion detection software is used to pinpoint the blink of a user's eye. A double-blink switches the mouse on.



Dmitry has a nose for innovation

## Klingonese, The New Lingo



The Klingon ambassador congratulates Erik Bettermann of Deutsche Welle

**B**umpy-headed aliens from the Class M planet Qo'noS can now get the latest news beamed live from the *Third Rock from the Sun*, *The Milky Way*, *The Spiral Arm*. German broadcaster Deutsche Welle (DW) recently added Klingon, spoken by the alien species from the science-fiction franchise *Star Trek*, to the 30 languages used on its Web site.

The pages at <http://klingon.dwworld.de/english/index.php> were added to celebrate the site's 10th anniversary. The

portal-within-a-portal covers snippets of information on the Klingons, their customs, their rituals, their history and their culture. "The dialogue of cultures does not end at the edge of our solar system," Deutsche Welle Director Erik Bettermann said. The sentiment will surely be shared by the late Gene Roddenberry, the creator of *Star Trek*.

Deutsche Welle was Germany's first public broadcaster to go online in 1994 ([www.dwelle.de](http://www.dwelle.de)).

### 3-Easy-Steps to Freebies!

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- 2 Enter this 16-digit code and score points (you will find your code at this place every issue)
- 3 Your points get added every month and can be redeemed for exciting gifts!

